



FREE GUIDE · FOR RESEARCH & ACADEMIC LABS

The Research Lab's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Chemicals, biologicals, sharps, and research controls — every stream, characterized right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Four streams, four rulebooks.

Research and academic labs generate waste that spans four different rulebooks: hazardous chemicals (EPA RCRA), biological and biohazard, sharps (including broken glass and pipette tips), and — for many labs — controlled substances used in research under a DEA registration. Getting each into the right path is the whole job. This guide covers every stream. (We don't handle radioactive waste — we'll point you to a licensed provider for that.)

The good news

One partner can characterize and destroy your chemical, biological, sharps, and controlled research waste — with manifests, Form 41 where needed, and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Hazardous chemical waste

Solvents, reagents, and spent chemicals from the bench.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Spent solvents & reagents
- Listed & characteristic hazardous chemicals
- Contaminated lab consumables

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous waste
- Sharps
- Biohazard / red-bag waste

THE RULE · EPA RCRA and DOT — characterize, segregate by compatibility, manifest, and destroy to EPA standards.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous handling with manifests.

Tip

Characterize your chemicals first — the RCRA listing or characteristic sets the disposal path.

WASTE STREAM 02

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Cultures, biological materials, and contaminated labware.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Cultures & biological materials
- Contaminated pipettes & plates
- Blood & OPIM materials

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 03

Sharps

Needles, blades, broken glass, and pipette tips.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles & blades
- Broken glass & pastettes
- Contaminated pipette tips

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 04

Controlled substances

Controlled substances used in research, under your DEA registration.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused research controls
- Wasted research quantities
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled destruction to DEA standards, with documentation.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The research lab compliance checklist.

- ☐ Chemicals characterized (listed vs. characteristic) and segregated by compatibility.
- ☐ Biological and culture waste treated/destroyed per protocol and state rules.
- ☐ Sharps — including broken glass and pipette tips — in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Research controlled substances rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Manifests and Certificates of Destruction retained for EH&S; and audits.
- ☐ Radioactive waste routed to a licensed provider (not us).

QUESTIONS LABS ASK

Your research lab questions, answered.

How do we dispose of spent solvents and reagents?

As RCRA-hazardous waste — characterized, segregated by compatibility, manifested, and destroyed to EPA standards.

Can you handle controlled substances used in research?

Yes — expired or unused research controls are rendered non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41, consistent with your registration.

Do you take radioactive waste?

No — that requires a specially licensed provider. We'll point you in the right direction and handle everything else.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle characterizes and destroys your lab's chemical, biological, sharps, and controlled research waste — mail-back kits or scheduled pickup, with manifests, Form 41 where needed, and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Solvents / reagents	RCRA-hazardous handling (manifested)

Waste stream	The right path
Cultures / biologicals	Biohazard kit or pickup
Needles / broken glass	Sharps mail-back kit
Research controls	Controlled destruction (Form 41)

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Higher-volume or multi-lab facilities usually prefer scheduled pickup with manifests. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY RESEARCH & ACADEMIC LABS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your research lab waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop